الطالب الأكاديمي
THE ACADEMIC STUDENT

Faculty of Business Studies

BUS310 - Strategic Management: Creating Competitiv Advantages

Mid-term Examination (Form B)

2025-2026 / Spring
21 – April – 2026

Number of Exam Pages: 2 (including this cover sheet)	Time Allowed: 2 hours

Instructions:

ALL QUESTIONS ARE COMPULSORY

- This examination consists of **Three (3) questions**. Answer **All Three** questions.
- The marks for each part of the question are next to the question.
- The MTA is worth **30 %** of the total course assessment.
- Use the Answer Booklet provided to you to answer the questions, and do not forge your name, student number and section number in the specified space on the cov Answer Booklet.
- Write in black or blue ink only.
- Do not remove this question paper from the examination room unless the invig given you permission to do so.
- You are expected to refer to course materials, provide critical analysis, and use illustrations, and practical examples from your own experience, where applicable.
- At the end of the examination, candidates must remain seated until the invigilators collected and checked all the Answer Booklets.
- Any form of cheating will NOT be tolerated and will subject you to AOU Cheating F
- You should keep the organization of the exam paper neat, use good English, and clearly using good handwriting.
- Any work crossed through will NOT be marked.

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Answer all the following questions:

Question One (33 Marks)

Explain the importance of a firm's mission statement (10 marks) and how it influences its strategy (10 marks). Discuss any five characteristics of an effective mission statement (10 marks). Illustrate your answer with real life examples (3 marks)

Question Two (33 Marks)

Organizational resources vary between tangible and those which are intangible. Differentiate between tangible (15 marks) and intangible (15 marks) resources of firms. Support your answer with relevant examples. (3 marks)

Question Three (34 Marks)

Diversification involves companies expanding their operations into new businesses. Describe the differences between forward and backward integration strategies (4 marks). Explain five guidelines behind a company's decision to adopt forward integration strategies (25 marks). Provide relevant example for each guideline to support your answer (5 marks)

-End of questions-

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